

The post-pandemic factor

The outbreak of coronavirus has introduced many changes in how things happen across the world. Looking at these changes with a digital transformation perspective in mind, the number of challenges that can be turned into opportunities are plenty. Technologies like AI, ML, and IoT—which make a critical part of digital strategy—will rise exponentially from here.

“There is no normalcy like before. People have seen new things. Some they like and some they do not. We are not going back to the same world we used to live in before the coronavirus pandemic hit. If you look at it from the digital transformation perspective, there are plenty of problems waiting to be solved. So far it has been a steady growth, but from here you will see an exponential growth in adoption of digital technologies like IoT,” explains Tamboli.

The global industrial IoT market, as per a report by Mordor Intelligence, was valued at US\$313.27 billion in 2019, and it is expected to reach a value of US\$607.73 billion by 2025, registering a CAGR of 12.3 per cent over the forecast period of 2020 to 2025. Significant advantages, such as large-scale profit margins through improvements in power efficiency, are attracting companies to invest in the market aggressively.

According to a study by Microsoft in 2019, IoT is increasingly becoming indispensable to the manufacturing industry. Eighty-seven per cent of IoT decision-makers in the industry have adopted IoT, and the vast majority say IoT is critical to the success of their company and are satisfied with the technology.

Next in line comes the data generated. IDC states that there will be about 40 billion connected devices by the end of 2025. It would be impossible to make use of the data that these 40 billion devices generate without knowing how to leverage digital technologies, which again is a part of digital strategy followed by any company.



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“Data is the new oil and without having a proper digital strategy in place, it would be impossible for the companies to mine this data,” says Dikshit.

Think of a company selling smart lights to end consumers in the market. Now this company, if it knows how to mine data, can cross-sell/upsell other smart products like ceiling fans using the same app that the consumers are using to operate those smart lights. However, this will only be possible if the company has a digital strategy in place and has teams working on that aspect. Otherwise, the data generated by the app downloads might keep sitting in the company’s servers for years without anyone knowing what to do with it!

Having a digital strategy in place can also help your organisation to start working on a new product development, in normal or in pandemic times. Medical ventilators never received the attention of the market before the pandemic occurred, but during the pandemic these got the attention and focus not only from the governments worldwide but also from the companies that made components for these life-saving medical devices. In fact, a lot of companies were allowed to operate during the pandemic times due to their capability of producing components for these devices.

“While the demand for ventilators was somehow met during the pandemic times, would it have been the same case

if companies manufacturing these, as a part of digital strategy, were enabling ventilators with IoT capabilities? Not only could such companies have benefitted from servicing the ventilators without physically being available there, but it would have also been easier for the hospitals to monitor health of patients remotely,” explains Lakshmanan.

One of the key things that most of the companies miss in their digital strategy is keeping ahead of time. Even though it may not be possible to predict perfectly well, at least constantly thinking of what the next big thing could be should always be a part of the long-term digital strategy. This can be done by companies that know their customers well, and at the same time also keep an eye on the market trends. Both these aspects, again, hint towards having a good digital strategy in place, according to Tamboli.

He adds, “Thinking three steps ahead about where you can use digital strategy is what really adds value to the overall idea. Working on the problems in a supply chain via the digital route is more effective when your approach is ahead of the problem, and less effective when it’s done after the problem hits you.” 

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The article was originally published in the May 2021 issue of Electronics For You.